

You must redact (mask) protected information in public documents as described in [Rule 16.605](#).

DO NOT include protected information in a document if it is not material to the case or required by law. If you do not know whether the information is material or required, consult an attorney.

- **If you are creating the document**, follow the instructions in the next section under *Redacting Protected Information in Electronic Documents*.
- **If you are filing an original**, such as a birth certificate, follow the instructions under *Redacting Protected Information in Printed Documents*.

Protected Information Disclosure Form

Get a Protected Information Disclosure form by going to iowacourts.gov/for-the-public/court-forms/ and searching for the keyword “protected”.

- **If a Protected Information Disclosure form has already been filed on your case**, use the redacted information from that form in your document.
- **If information is changed**, added, or is incorrect, update the Protected Information Disclosure form.

Note: You do not need to redact protected information from documents that are confidential by statute, rule, or court order. If you do not know if your case or document is confidential, check the [Restricted Documents and Case Types \(PDF\)](#).

Redacting Protected Information in Electronic Documents

1. Create your document. Only include the partial version of the information (“redacted information”).

Type	Protected Information	Redacted Information
Social security number	123-45-6890	XXX-XX-XXX0
Financial account numbers	1234-2453-0010-8222	XXXX-XXXX-XXXX-XX22
Date of birth	04/20/1957	XX/XX/1957
Names of minor children	Maree Angela Brown	MAB or Child 1
	Max Aaron Brown	MAB2 or Child 2
Individual taxpayer identification numbers	12-5650003	XX-XXXXXX3
Personal identification numbers	16161	XX161
Other unique identifying numbers	PM123423	XXXXX423 or PMXXXXX3

Note: Do not electronically cover text by drawing a black rectangle, highlighting it in black, reducing its size, or changing its color to white. It is easy to uncover text that has been masked by these methods.

- Fill out a Protected Information Disclosure form with the complete protected information and the redacted (partial) version.

Plaintiff / Petitioner		
Name: (Last) <u>Doe</u> (First) <u>John</u> (Middle) <u>David</u>		
Protected Information Type	Protected Information	Public Information (Redacted)
Social security number	123-45-6890	xxx-xx-xxx0
Financial account numbers	1234-2453-0010-8222	xxxx-xxxx-xxxx-xx22
Date of birth	2/11/1962	1962
Individual taxpayer identification numbers	12-5650003	xx-xxxxxx3
Personal identification numbers	16161	xxxx1
Other unique identifying numbers	PM123	PMxx3 or xxxx3

- Log into the eFile system.
- Add the original document to your case filing, using the appropriate document type.
- Add the Protected Information Disclosure to your filing, using the **Protected Information Form** document type.
- When you have added all the documents, click **Next**.
- Click **Submit the Filing**.

Redacting Protected Information in Printed Documents

To redact protected information in original documents (such as wills, birth certificates, or mortgage documents):

- Make a copy of the original document.
- Black out the protected information on the copy with a black marker or white it out with correction fluid.



- Scan and save the original document as a .pdf.
- Scan the redacted copy as a .pdf, naming it clearly as the redaction.
- Log into the eFile system.
- Select **Existing Case** and open your case (not illustrated).
- Add the original (unredacted) document to your submission.

- Add the redacted copy to the submission.
- Use **Redaction** as the Document Category and as the Document Type.

Document Category

Document Type *

- Browse for and select the redacted version of the document.
- Click **Add**.

8. Select the original document from the list and click **Next**.

Previously Filed Documents

	Document Name	Date Filed	Filed by or in behalf of
☐	- VERIFICATION OF ACCT HAS BEEN FILED	12-28-2015	AMY K SWANSON
☐	- SMALL CLAIMS ORIGINAL NOTICE	12-28-2015	AMY K SWANSON
☐	- APPEARANCE AND ANSWER FOR SMALL CLAIMS	01-04-2016	AMY AUGUST
☐	- MOTION	01-06-2016	AMY K SWANSON
☐	- MOTION	01-10-2016	AMY K SWANSON
☐	- OTHER AFFIDAVIT	01-11-2016	AMY K SWANSON

Documents in this filing

☒ AFFIDAVIT OF FINANCIAL STATUS

9. In the Add a Document window, add any additional documents you want to include in the filing, and then click **Next**.
10. Click **Submit the Filing**.

What if I have been excused from the rules of electronic registration and electronic filing?

You still must redact protected information from the public documents that you submit on paper to the court. Deliver the documents in paper to the clerk of court for electronic filing.

What if an exhibit I am offering contains protected information?

You must redact protected information in exhibits you file or offer in court per rule 16.601(3). Use the appropriate method to redact electronically filed exhibits or paper exhibits.

Appendix A. Other Information Can Be Treated as Protected

The following information *can* be redacted but does not *need* to be.

- Driver's license number
- Information concerning medical treatments or diagnosis
- Employment history
- Personal financial information

- Proprietary or trade secret information
- Information concerning a person's cooperation with the government
- Information concerning crime victims
- Sensitive security information
- Home addresses

This information is for instructional purposes only and is not intended to and does not constitute legal advice under any circumstance.